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General Knowledge

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STUDY NOTES

Commonwealth

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The Commonwealth Games is an **international multi-sport event** that brings together athletes from the Commonwealth of Nations, a political association of mostly former British Empire territories. **It is held every four years** and celebrates its member countries' unity, diversity, and athleticism.

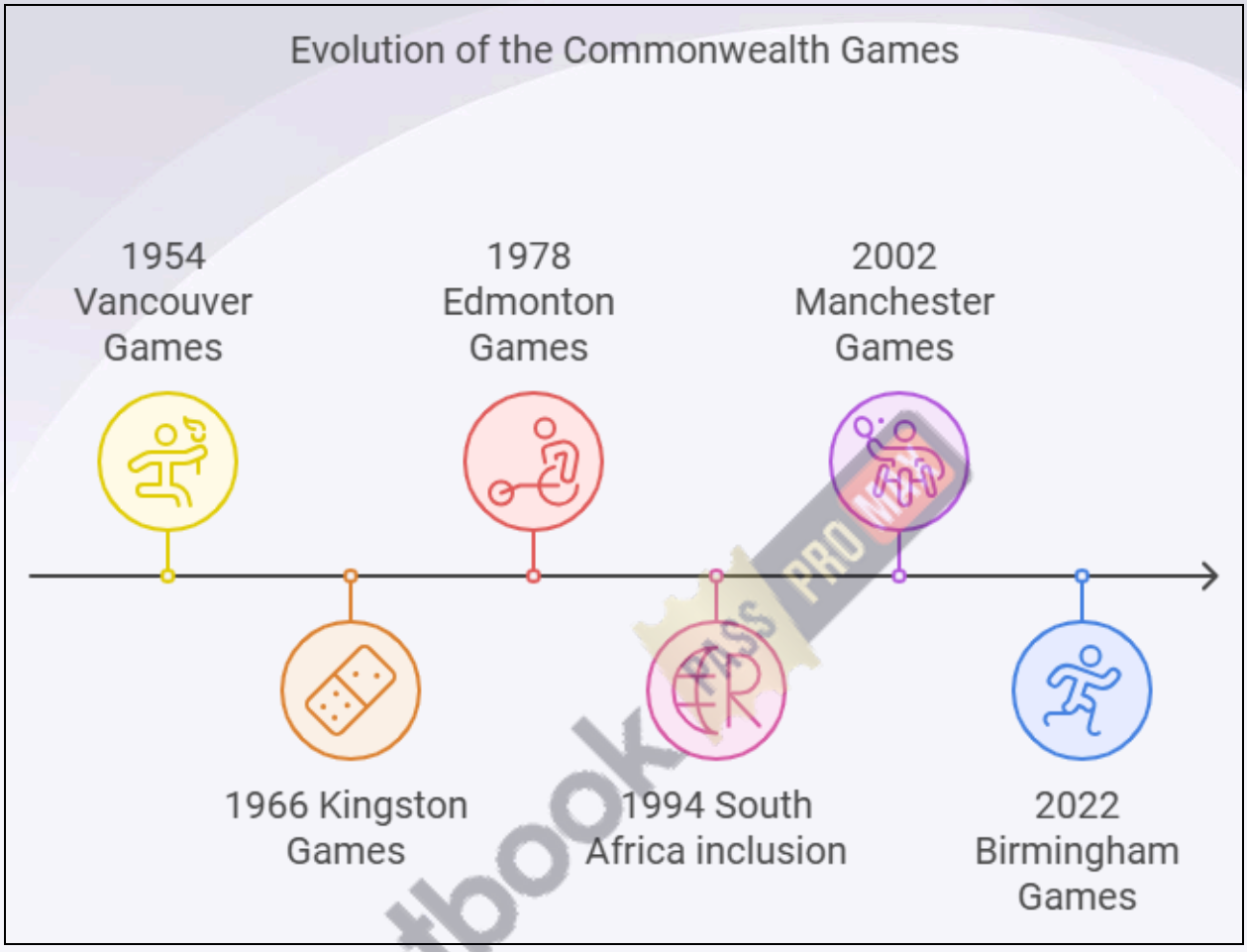
History

- The idea of the Commonwealth Games was conceived by Reverend Astley Cooper in 1891, who envisioned a "Pan-Britannic" festival to foster goodwill and camaraderie among the colonies. However, the first official games took place much later.
- **First Games (1930)**: Known initially as the British Empire Games, the first event was held in Hamilton, Canada, in **1930**. Eleven countries participated, with around 400 athletes competing in six sports.
- Over the years, the Games underwent several name changes, reflecting the political changes within the Commonwealth. It became the British Empire and Commonwealth Games in 1954, the **British Commonwealth Games in 1970**, and finally the **Commonwealth Games in 1978**.

Significance

- **Global Participation**: The Commonwealth Games has grown in scale, with over 70 nations and territories participating today. It is one of the few multi-sport events that unites countries across continents.
- **Platform for Smaller Nations**: Unlike larger events like the Olympics, the Commonwealth Games often provide a unique opportunity for athletes from smaller nations to gain international recognition.
- **Gender Equality**: The Games have been at the forefront of promoting gender equality in sports. In recent editions, they have achieved a balanced schedule with equal medal opportunities for men and women.
- **Youth Engagement**: Since 2000, the Commonwealth Youth Games have been introduced to nurture young talent, encouraging future participation in the main event.

Key Milestones



Commonwealth Games Federation (CGF)

Aspect	Details
Organization	Commonwealth Games Federation (CGF)
Founded	1932
Mission	To foster peace, unity, and sports excellence among Commonwealth nations.
Core Values	Humanity, Equality, Destiny (focus on diversity, inclusivity, and social progress through sports).
Leadership	President and Executive Board

Membership	72 Commonwealth countries and territories
Role of Representatives	Decision-making and strategic direction shaping
Programs	Youth and community development through sport, sustainability, and inclusivity.
Host City Collaboration	Ensuring high standards in sports and infrastructure, leaving a positive legacy.
Governing Bodies	CGF Executive Board and General Assembly (policy-making, financial decisions, and strategic planning).
Diversity	Includes athletes from developed, developing, and small island nations, representing various continents, cultures, and economies.

Unique Sports in the Commonwealth Games

Some sports are unique to the Commonwealth Games or more prevalent within Commonwealth countries, like:

- **Rugby Sevens**: Although rugby union is popular worldwide, Rugby Sevens is especially significant within the Commonwealth and isn't typically part of other multi-sport events.
- **Lawn Bowls**: This precision sport is less commonly seen outside the Commonwealth but holds a firm place within the Games' roster

Indian Participation in the Commonwealth Games

India has a long history in the Commonwealth Games, having first participated in 1934. Since then, India has been an active participant, achieving notable success in various sports.

Achievements in Key Sports:

- **Shooting**: India has won numerous medals in shooting, historically being one of the country's strongest events.
- **Wrestling**: Indian wrestlers have consistently performed well, with numerous gold medals across weight categories.
- **Badminton**: India has achieved significant success in badminton, particularly through athletes like Saina Nehwal, P.V. Sindhu, and Kidambi Srikanth.

- **Weightlifting**: India's weightlifters, including Mirabai Chanu, have won several medals, showcasing strength and determination on the global stage.

Notable Athletes:

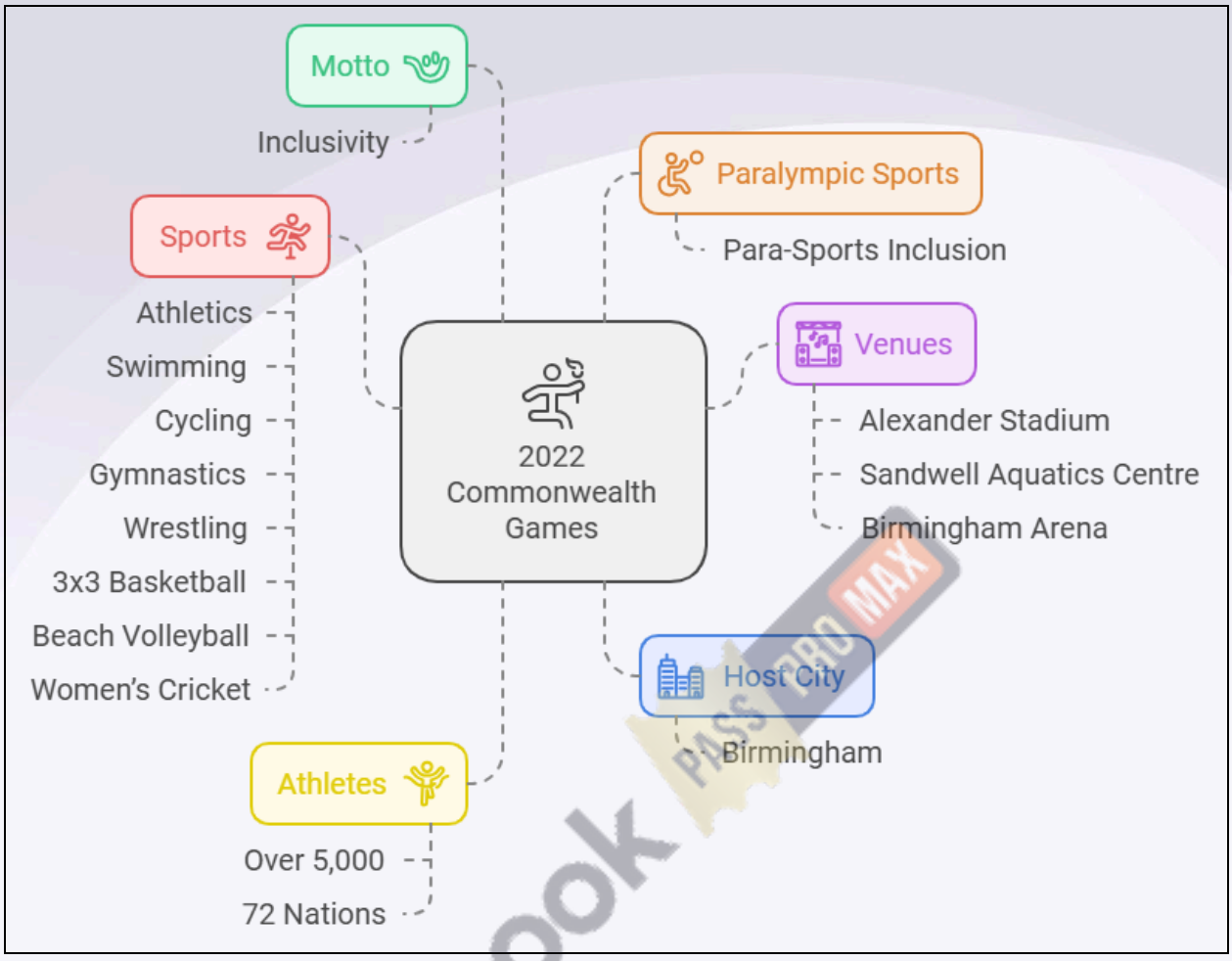
- **Milkha Singh**: Known as the "Flying Sikh," Milkha Singh is a legendary athlete who competed in athletics during the early years of India's participation.
- **Saina Nehwal & P.V. Sindhu**: These two badminton stars have won multiple medals, bringing significant attention to the sport in India.
- **Abhinav Bindra**: India's first individual Olympic gold medalist, Bindra's contributions to shooting also include Commonwealth success.
- **Mary Kom**: A six-time world champion, Mary Kom has won medals for India in boxing at the Commonwealth Games.

Commonwealth Games Winners: Last 5 Editions

Year	Host City	Overall Winner	Total Medals	Gold Medals	Silver Medals	Bronze Medals
2022	Birmingham, England	Australia	181	67	57	54
2018	Gold Coast, Australia	Australia	198	80	59	59
2014	Glasgow, Scotland	Australia	174	49	42	44
2010	Delhi, India	Australia	177	74	55	48
2006	Melbourne, Australia	Australia	221	84	69	68

Commonwealth Games 2022, Birmingham, England

The 2022 Commonwealth Games were held in Birmingham, England, from July 28 to August 8, 2022. This was the third time Birmingham hosted the Games, having previously held them in 1934.



Notable Highlights:

- **India's Performance:** India finished in 4th place in the medal tally with 61 medals, including 22 gold, 16 silver, and 23 bronze.
- **England's Success**: As the host country, England topped the medal tally with a total of 176 medals, including 57 gold.
- **Women's Cricket:** The Games featured a women's T20 cricket tournament for the first time, with Australia winning the gold medal.
- **Athletics:** The Games saw impressive performances in track and field, with Jamaica's Elaine Thompson-Herah claiming the gold in the women's 100 meters.